

Warm-Ups & Exit Tickets

Every class opens with a quick-write or forced choice that pulls out what students already think, and closes with an exit ticket that checks what landed and takes the room's temperature. A zero-prep set of universal routines, plus a tuned warm-up and exit ticket for every concept in the library.

How to use this. OPEN → Project or read a warm-up in the first 3–5 minutes. Students write or pick before any teaching — the goal is to surface prior belief, not to be right. Don't correct answers; collect the thinking. CLOSE → In the last 3–5 minutes, project an exit ticket. Students answer on a slip, a card, or a shared doc. Read a handful aloud or scan them after class as a temperature check. **Universal routines (§01) work with any lesson, no prep.** The concept bank (§02–06) gives a tuned pair for each primer. Forced-choice prompts are marked **FORCED CHOICE**; the rest are quick-writes.

01 Universal Routines — Any Lesson, No Prep

Drop these onto any concept on any day. Print them once and keep them by the projector. The reform-test closer (bottom right) is the curriculum's signature exit ticket — it works after almost any lesson.

WARM-UPS · OPEN THE CLASS

FORCED CHOICE More good or more harmful? "Today's idea is [X]. On balance, is it more good or more harmful for ordinary people?" Pick a side, write one sentence of defense. Reveal the split, then teach into the disagreement.	QUICK-WRITE What do you already know? "Write everything you think you know about [X] in 2 minutes — even guesses." Surfaces prior knowledge and misconceptions you can build on or correct.
QUICK-WRITE Where have you seen it? "Where have you run into [X] in your own life, the news, or online?" Anchors an abstract idea to something concrete before you name it.	FORCED CHOICE Agree or disagree Offer a provocative one-sentence claim about today's concept. "Agree or disagree, and why?" Take a quick standing vote, then begin.
QUICK-WRITE Who benefits, who pays?	FORCED CHOICE Gut call

"When you hear the phrase [X], who do you imagine benefits, and who pays?" Primes the distribution lens the curriculum returns to constantly.	Pose the lesson's central tension as a binary before students have the tools. They'll revisit their gut answer at the exit ticket — and see if learning moved them.
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EXIT TICKETS · CLOSE THE CLASS

TEMPERATURE CHECK One thing + one question "Name one thing you understand now that you didn't at the start — and one question you still have." Fast read of what landed and what's foggy.	REFORM TEST The smallest reform "What's the smallest change you'd make to what we studied that would grow the economy while expanding democracy — and what would it cost?" The signature closer; works after nearly any lesson.
TEMPERATURE CHECK Confidence dial (1–5) "Rate 1–5 how well you could explain [X] to a friend, and write the one part you'd stumble on." A number plus a target for tomorrow.	QUICK-WRITE Did your mind move? "You took a side at the start. Are you in the same place now? What, if anything, moved you?" Pairs with any forced-choice warm-up.
QUICK-WRITE Explain it to a 10-year-old "In two sentences, no jargon, explain today's concept to a 10-year-old." Forces real understanding into plain language.	QUICK-WRITE Steelman the other side "Give the single best argument for the view you <i>disagree</i> with." Checks whether students can hold both sides — the core habit of the course.

02 Concept Bank — Allocation

A tuned warm-up and exit ticket for each primer. Find your concept, grab the pair. Forced-choice openers are marked; the rest are quick-writes.

CONCEPT	WARM-UP (OPEN)	EXIT TICKET (CLOSE)
Scarcity	QUICK-WRITE Name something you wanted this week but couldn't have. What had to be given up to get something else?	If everything were free and unlimited, would we still need economics? Explain in two sentences.
Opportunity Cost	FORCED CHOICE You have a free hour: earn \$15, or study for a test. Pick one — then name exactly what you gave up.	Describe one real choice you made today and the true cost of it (what you gave up, not what you paid).

CONCEPT	WARM-UP (OPEN)	EXIT TICKET (CLOSE)
Incentives	QUICK-WRITE Describe a time a reward or punishment changed your behavior. Did it work the way it was meant to?	Give one example of an incentive that backfired — produced the opposite of what was intended. Why?

03 Concept Bank — Engines

CONCEPT	WARM-UP (OPEN)	EXIT TICKET (CLOSE)
Profit Motive	FORCED CHOICE Is the desire for profit mostly a force for good or for harm in society? Pick one, defend in a sentence.	Name one thing the profit motive does well and one thing it does badly. Did your opening view hold?
Compounding	FORCED CHOICE A penny doubled daily for 30 days, or \$1 million today? Pick — then we'll check.	Explain in one sentence why compounding is called the most powerful force in finance — for wealth <i>and</i> debt.
Competition	QUICK-WRITE Name a business you love. Who are its competitors — and how does that rivalry affect you?	When does competition help the customer, and when can it stop helping? Give one example of each.
Productivity	QUICK-WRITE If a worker produces twice as much per hour as last year, who should get the gains? Write your gut answer.	Productivity rose for decades but typical wages lagged. Who got the difference — and is that a problem?
Creative Destruction	QUICK-WRITE Name a product or job that barely exists anymore. What replaced it, and who won and lost?	Is the constant destruction of old industries a price worth paying for progress? Defend your view.
Business Cycles	FORCED CHOICE A recession is: (a) the system failing, or (b) the system correcting. Pick one before we start.	If a downturn clears out excess and renews the economy, why does it still matter who bears the cost?

04 Concept Bank — Power

CONCEPT	WARM-UP (OPEN)	EXIT TICKET (CLOSE)
Monopoly	FORCED CHOICE One company controls a thing you need. Good (it's efficient) or bad (it's powerful)? Pick.	Name one way a monopoly can help customers and one way it can harm them. Which usually wins?
Network Effects	QUICK-WRITE Why do you use the apps you use? How much is it because everyone else does?	Explain why "the best product" and "the one everyone uses" aren't always the same thing.

CONCEPT	WARM-UP (OPEN)	EXIT TICKET (CLOSE)
Economies of Scale	QUICK-WRITE Why can a giant store sell cheaper than a corner shop? List every reason you can think of.	If bigger means cheaper, what's the danger of letting the biggest firms keep getting bigger?
Rent-Seeking	FORCED CHOICE Two ways to get rich: build something valuable, or capture value others made. Which describes most fortunes?	Give one example of creating value and one of capturing it. How would you tell them apart in the news?
Sovereignty	QUICK-WRITE Name something you depend on that you don't control. What power does that give whoever provides it?	"More self-sufficient" usually means "poorer but freer." Where would you set that dial, and why?
The Trust	QUICK-WRITE Should someone be able to control money they don't own, on behalf of someone else? When is that good?	The same structure protects a child and entrenches a dynasty. What real difference could the law key on?

05 Concept Bank — Distribution

CONCEPT	WARM-UP (OPEN)	EXIT TICKET (CLOSE)
The Commons	QUICK-WRITE Name something everyone shares and no one owns. What keeps it from being wrecked — or doesn't?	Is a shared resource doomed without private owners, or can a community govern it? Give your reasoning.
Predistribution	FORCED CHOICE To fix inequality: broaden who owns assets, or tax-and-transfer after? Pick one before we start.	Making people owners gives a stake but hands them risk. When is that better than a cash transfer?
Labor	QUICK-WRITE Is your labor "just a commodity" like anything else bought and sold? Write your first reaction.	One unemployment number hides three kinds (frictional, structural, cyclical). Why does telling them apart matter?

06 Concept Bank — Money & Value

CONCEPT	WARM-UP (OPEN)	EXIT TICKET (CLOSE)
Ownership & Equity	QUICK-WRITE What's the difference between using something and owning it? Why might owning matter more over time?	Explain why two people earning the same wage can end up with very different wealth.
Inflation	QUICK-WRITE If prices and your pay both doubled, are you better off, worse off, or the same? Think it through.	Inflation quietly moves wealth between people. Who tends to win from it, and who loses?

CONCEPT	WARM-UP (OPEN)	EXIT TICKET (CLOSE)
Wages & Assets	FORCED CHOICE Which builds more wealth over a life: a high salary, or owning appreciating assets? Pick.	Why has "work hard and earn a good wage" stopped guaranteeing wealth the way it once did?
Wealth of Nations	QUICK-WRITE What actually makes one country richer than another? List your best guesses.	Name one thing that genuinely grows a nation's wealth — and one thing that just moves it around.
Wealth of the Nation	QUICK-WRITE If a country's total wealth grew, would you assume everyone got richer? Why or why not?	A rising national total can hide who actually gained. What would you want to look at underneath it?
Data	FORCED CHOICE The data you generate online: yours, or the platform's? Pick a side and defend it.	Your data is nearly worthless alone but immensely valuable in bulk. Who should capture that value?
Cryptocurrency	QUICK-WRITE What makes a dollar in your pocket actually worth anything? Write your honest theory.	If all money runs on shared belief, what makes a national currency more stable than most crypto?
The Corporation	QUICK-WRITE The law treats a company as a "person." What's useful about that — and what's strange?	A corporation can be built for shareholders, members, or a mission. Who do you think it should serve?
P&L vs. Balance Sheet	FORCED CHOICE Friend A earns a lot but owns nothing; Friend B earns little but owns a home. Who's "doing fine"?	Explain how a company can be profitable and going bankrupt at the same time.
Credit	QUICK-WRITE Is borrowing money smart or dangerous? Write the case for your gut answer.	The same loan can build wealth or bury someone. What decides which it does?
Debt	QUICK-WRITE When someone can't repay a debt, who should bear the loss — and does the scale change your answer?	A debt is fixed while the world changes. Explain how that shifts risk onto the borrower.
Banking & Central Banks	FORCED CHOICE Where does most money come from: (a) the government prints it, or (b) banks create it by lending? Guess.	If banks create money when they lend, who benefits from being closest to that new money?